

# INTERIM BEHAVIOUR SUPPORT PLAN

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| Client Information | Details        |
|--------------------|----------------|
| Client Name        | John Smith     |
| Primary Diagnosis  | Schizophrenia  |
| Support Worker     | Jane Doe       |
| BSP Coordinator    | Bob Jones      |
| Date Created       | 18 August 2026 |

**Review Date: 3 months from date of plan**

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## 1. BACKGROUND AND CONTEXT

Background and Context:

John Smith is a person living with schizophrenia, a complex mental health condition that can significantly impact his thinking, perception, emotions, language, and behavior. As a result of his diagnosis, John may experience hallucinations, delusions, and disorganized thinking, which can contribute to episodes of verbal aggression towards support workers during personal care routines. These behaviors of concern occur several times per week and are often triggered by loud noises and unexpected changes to his daily routine. It is essential to understand that these behaviors are not a choice but rather a manifestation of John's condition, highlighting the importance of providing appropriate support and intervention strategies.

In order to effectively support John and address his verbal aggression towards support workers, it is crucial to implement proactive strategies that focus on managing his schizophrenia symptoms and reducing potential triggers. Consistent medication management in line with the prescribed plan, maintaining regular and predictable sleep schedules, and minimizing exposure to stressful situations are key proactive measures that can help decrease the frequency of behavioral episodes. Additionally, monitoring for early warning signs of increased agitation or withdrawal and maintaining regular contact with the mental health treatment team are essential components of John's support plan. Encouraging his participation in meaningful daily activities can also contribute to his overall well-being and potentially reduce the likelihood of verbal aggression episodes. By

understanding the nature of schizophrenia and its impact on John's behavior, support workers can tailor their approach to provide person-centered care that meets his specific needs and promotes a positive support environment.

Furthermore, recognizing the triggers associated with John's verbal aggression, such as loud noises and unexpected changes to his daily routine, allows support workers to anticipate and prevent potential escalation of behaviors. By creating a calm and predictable support environment, providing advance notice of any changes, and supporting John to develop personalized coping strategies, support workers can help mitigate the impact of these triggers on his behavior. It is essential to approach John's care with empathy, patience, and a deep understanding of the challenges he faces due to his schizophrenia diagnosis. Through a holistic and person-centered approach that integrates proactive and reactive strategies, support workers can promote John's well-being, enhance his quality of life, and foster a positive and supportive care environment for him.

## **2. DESCRIPTION OF BEHAVIOUR**

John Smith, diagnosed with schizophrenia, exhibits verbal aggression towards support workers during personal care routines several times per week. This behaviour of concern may be triggered by loud noises and unexpected changes to his daily routine. Schizophrenia is a serious mental health condition that can lead to distortions in thinking, perception, emotions, language, and behavior. Individuals with schizophrenia, like John, may experience hallucinations, delusions, and disorganized thinking. The frequency and intensity of these episodes can vary, often triggered by stress or changes in medication.

To address John's verbal aggression, proactive strategies should be implemented by support workers. Consistent medication management in line with the prescribed plan is crucial to reduce the frequency of behavioral episodes. Maintaining regular and predictable sleep schedules can also contribute to managing his condition. Minimizing exposure to stressful situations and environments, such as loud noises, and avoiding unexpected changes to his daily routine are essential proactive measures. Monitoring for early warning signs of increased agitation or withdrawal and maintaining regular contact with the mental health treatment team are vital components of John's support plan.

When supporting John during episodes of verbal aggression, it is important for support workers to remain calm and avoid confrontation. Using simple, clear, and direct communication can help de-escalate the situation. Creating a safe, quiet, and low-stimulation environment is crucial during these times. It is essential to respect John's personal space and maintain a safe physical distance. If the behavior escalates or there is a risk of harm to John or others, contacting the support coordinator is necessary. By implementing these reactive strategies and providing person-centered support, John can receive the care he needs during challenging moments.

### **3. REACTIVE STRATEGIES**

When supporting John during episodes of verbal aggression towards support workers, it is essential for the support workers to remain calm and avoid confrontation at all times. By maintaining a composed demeanor, support workers can help de-escalate the situation and prevent further distress for John. Using simple, clear, and direct communication is crucial in effectively communicating with John during these challenging moments. It is important not to argue with or challenge any delusional beliefs that John may express, as this could potentially exacerbate his distress and escalate the situation.

Creating a safe and quiet environment for John is key in managing his verbal aggression. Minimizing unnecessary stimulation, such as loud noises or disruptions, can help reduce triggers that may contribute to his aggressive behavior. Respecting John's personal space and maintaining a safe physical distance can also aid in preventing any escalation of the situation. If the behavior escalates or there is a risk of harm to John or others, it is imperative to contact the support coordinator promptly for further assistance and intervention.

In addition to these reactive strategies, it is important for support workers to be aware of John's triggers, such as loud noises and unexpected changes to his daily routine. By understanding these triggers, support workers can proactively work towards minimizing potential stressors and creating a more predictable and supportive environment for John. Through a combination of reactive and proactive strategies, support workers can effectively support John in managing his verbal aggression and promoting a safe and positive care environment.

### **4. IMMEDIATE SUPPORT STRATEGIES**

Immediate Support Strategies for John involve a combination of proactive and reactive approaches to address his verbal aggression towards support workers during personal care routines. Given John's diagnosis of schizophrenia, it is crucial to consider the impact of his condition on his behaviours of concern. When John displays verbal aggression, support workers should respond calmly and avoid confrontation, as per reactive strategies for supporting individuals experiencing schizophrenia episodes. Using simple, clear, and direct communication can help de-escalate the situation and reduce distress for John. It is important not to challenge any potential delusional beliefs during these episodes to maintain a safe and supportive environment for John.

Additionally, implementing proactive strategies such as consistent medication management and maintaining regular sleep schedules can help reduce the frequency of John's

behavioural episodes. By monitoring for early warning signs of increased agitation or withdrawal, support workers can intervene early to prevent escalation. Providing meaningful daily activities and encouraging John's participation can also contribute to his overall well-being and potentially reduce his verbal aggression. Furthermore, support workers should be mindful of triggers such as loud noises and unexpected changes to daily routines, which may lead to John's verbal aggression. By minimizing exposure to these triggers and creating a calm and predictable support environment, support workers can help mitigate the likelihood of such behaviours occurring.

In situations where John displays verbal aggression, support workers should ensure the environment is safe, quiet, and free from unnecessary stimulation, aligning with reactive strategies for supporting individuals with schizophrenia. Maintaining a safe physical distance and respecting John's personal space are essential aspects of providing immediate support during these episodes. If the behaviour escalates or there is a risk of harm to John or others, it is crucial to involve the support coordinator promptly. By combining these immediate support strategies with ongoing proactive measures, support workers can effectively address John's verbal aggression and promote a positive and supportive care environment for him.

## SIGN OFF

|                                |       |
|--------------------------------|-------|
| Behaviour Support Practitioner | _____ |
| Participant / Guardian         | _____ |
| Support Worker                 | _____ |
| Date                           | _____ |

*This BSP has been generated based on internal resource documents only. All content must be reviewed and approved by a qualified Behaviour Support Practitioner before implementation.*